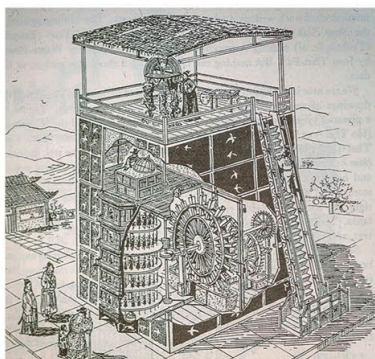




1086

DEFEAT OF ALFONSO VI OF LEON AND CASTILE

Alarmed at Christian gains on the Iberian peninsula, the emir of Seville called for help from the Almoravids – a Berber Muslim dynasty from North Africa. Almoravid forces under Yusuf ibn Tashfin defeated Christian armies under Alfonso VI at the Battle of Sagrajas in 1086. Although Yusuf ibn Tashfin temporarily withdrew to Africa, the Almoravids soon returned to reunite Islamic Spain and begin a northwards advance.



1092

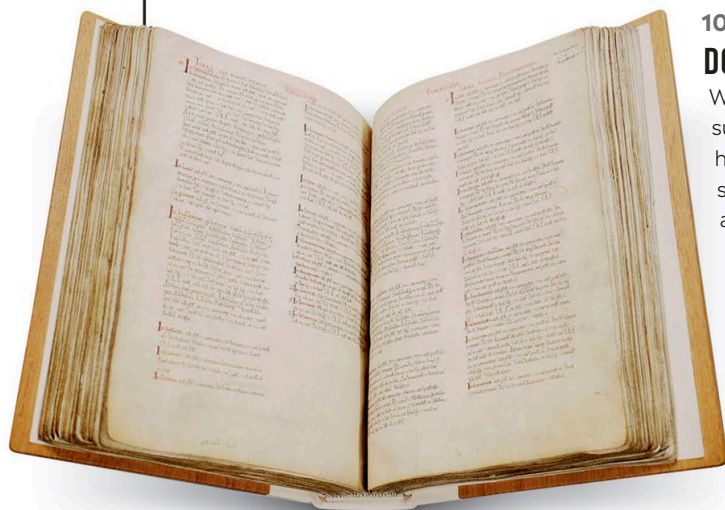
A CHINESE WATER CLOCK

The Chinese polymath and engineer Su Song built a water-driven clock in the Song capital of Kaifeng. Housed in a tower that was 12 m (40 ft) tall, the clock was powered by the fall of water between a series of buckets. It indicated the time of the day, the day of the month, and phase of the Moon. It was destroyed by invading Jurchens in 1126.

1080

1088 Bologna University,
Europe's oldest,
is founded in Italy

1092 The Seljuq Empire
begins to break up after the
death of Sultan
Malik Shah



1085

DOMESDAY BOOK COMMISSIONED

William of Normandy commissioned a great land survey to help assess the tax he could raise from his new English kingdom. Commissioners were sent out to record the current owners of land areas and the numbers of livestock and serfs on that land, and who had held that land at the time of Edward the Confessor (r.1042-66). The results were compiled in a central ledger.

< The Domesday Book

The Domesday Book records 13,418 settlements